

ERP Electronics Store

User Manual

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1. Getting Started

System Overview

ERP Electronics Store is a complete point-of-sale and e-commerce system for managing your electronics retail business. It supports three user roles: Owner (full admin), Employee (operations), and Customer (shopping).

Logging In

#	Action
1	Open the store website in your browser.
2	Click "Login" in the top navigation bar.
3	Enter your email address and password.
4	Click "Sign In" to access your dashboard.

□ If this is your first login, you may be prompted to change your password. See Chapter 23 for details.

Default Login Credentials

Owner	victorzacharia110@gmail.com
Employee	mathewzacharia@gmail.com
Customer	zachariakinyula@gmail.com

2. Owner Dashboard

The Owner Dashboard is your central hub. After logging in as owner, you see:

- Summary Statistics — Total Revenue, Total Orders, Total Products, and Total Employees at a glance.
- Sales Analytics Charts — Interactive bar and line charts showing Revenue vs Profit, Orders Trend, Items Sold, and Revenue by Category. Use the period selector to toggle between 6 and 12 months.
- AI Business Insights — AI-powered suggestions from Google Gemini analyzing your business data. Suggestions are categorized by priority (High/Medium/Low) and type (Inventory, Pricing, Marketing, Growth, Operations). Click "Refresh" to regenerate insights.
- Recent Orders — Quick view of the latest orders with status badges. Click "View All" to go to full Order Management.
- Quick Actions — Tiles to jump to Employees, Products, Orders, Reports, Inventory, Payment Settings, and Shipping Settings.
- Products Overview — Top products listed by name, brand, and price. Click "View All" for full product management.

3. Employee Management (Owner)

As the owner, you can manage your store employees from Owner → Employees. Employees help run your store — managing orders, inventory, customers, and support.

Viewing Employees

The employee list shows all registered employees with their name, email, branch, position, and status. Use the search bar to find specific employees, or click "View All" to see the full list.

Adding a New Employee

Click "Add Employee" and complete the registration form:

- Full Name, Email, and Phone number (required).
- Identification — provide either the NIDA number or the Voting ID card number.
- Branch — assign the employee to one of your branches (optional if no branches exist).
- Position and Department — e.g. Cashier / Sales, or Warehouse.
- Commission Rate (%) — the percentage the employee earns on sales (0-100).

Wadhamini (Guarantors)

Add at least one guarantor (Wadhamini) by clicking "Fill Wadhamini Form". Enter each guarantor's full name, phone, relationship, and address, then click "Add Guarantor". Guarantors vouch for the employee and can be edited later.

Attachments

You can attach the employee's contract, ID scans, and background check documents. Click "Choose Files", then set the type for each file (Contract, Background Check, or Other).

#	Action
1	Click "Create Employee" to finish.
2	The employee account is created with a default password = FULL NAME IN CAPITALS (e.g., "MATHEW ZACHARIA").
3	Share these credentials with the employee securely.

☐ Employees will be prompted to change their password on first login if it has been more than 3 days since creation.

Editing an Employee

Click the pencil (edit) icon on an employee's card to open the edit form. You can update their name, email, phone, identification, branch, position, department, commission rate, and their guarantors. Click "Save Changes" when done.

4. Branch Management (Owner)

If your business has multiple locations, you can manage branches from Owner → Branches. Branches are optional — the system works without them.

Viewing Branches

- All branches are displayed as cards with name, city, address, and phone.
- The default branch is marked with a badge.
- Use the search bar to find branches by name or city.

Adding a Branch

#	Action
1	Navigate to Owner → Branches.
2	Click "Add Branch".
3	Enter: Branch Name, City, Address, Phone.
4	Click "Save".

Assigning Employees to Branches

When creating or editing an employee, you can assign them to a branch. This links the employee to a specific location. Employees can also be reassigned at any time.

Setting a Default Branch

Click the star icon on any branch card to set it as the default. The default branch is pre-selected when creating new orders.

5. Product Management (Owner)

Manage your entire product catalog from Owner → Products.

Product List

- All products are displayed with name, brand, category, and price.
- Use the search bar to filter products by name or brand.
- Pagination shows 15 products per page by default. Click "View All" to see everything.

Adding a Product

#	Action
1	Click "Add Product" on the products page.
2	Fill in: Name, Brand, Description, Category (dropdown).
3	Upload a Product Image (max 5MB, JPG/PNG).
4	Add Product Variants — each variant needs: SKU, Color/Storage, Selling Price (TSh), Cost Price (TSh), and Stock quantity.
5	Click "Save" to create the product.

□ Cost price is used for profit calculations in analytics. Always enter accurate cost prices.

Editing a Product

Click the edit icon on any product row. Modify any field and click "Save". You can also add or remove variants during editing.

Deleting a Product

Click the delete icon on any product row. Confirm the deletion when prompted. Note: Products with existing orders cannot be deleted.

6. Payment Settings (Owner)

Configure payment methods from Owner → Payment Settings.

ClickPesa Integration

Toggle ClickPesa online payments on or off. When enabled, customers see ClickPesa as a payment option at checkout. When disabled, a "Coming Soon" message is shown.

Mobile Money Providers

Manage the payment numbers displayed to customers during checkout. You can:

- Add a new provider (e.g., M-Pesa, Airtel Money, Halopesa).
- Edit the phone number or icon class for existing providers.
- Toggle providers enabled/disabled.
- Delete a provider you no longer accept.

7. Shipping Settings (Owner)

Configure shipping costs from Owner → Shipping.

Delivery Routes

Define routes between cities (e.g., Dar es Salaam → Arusha). Each route has:

- Route Name — descriptive label.
- From City and To City — the origin and destination.
- Base Cost — minimum shipping fee in TSh.

Value-Based Pricing Rules

For each route, you can add pricing rules based on order value:

- Min Value and Max Value — order value range in TSh.
- Shipping Cost — the fee for orders in this range.

☐ Leave Max Value empty for "no upper limit". The system automatically calculates shipping at checkout based on these rules.

8. Reports & Analytics (Owner)

Daily Reports

Navigate to Owner → Reports to view daily sales reports. Reports are auto-generated at midnight each day.

- Select a date using the date picker.
- View: Total Orders, Total Revenue, Items Sold, Paid Orders, Pending Orders, Cancelled Orders.
- See Employee Performance stats and Top Products for the day.
- Click "Print" to print the report.

Sales Analytics (Dashboard)

The Owner Dashboard includes rich analytics:

- Revenue vs Profit — Bar chart comparing monthly revenue and profit.
- Orders Trend — Line chart of orders placed vs cancelled over time.
- Items Sold — Monthly items sold volume.
- Revenue by Category — Doughnut chart showing category distribution.
- Summary Cards — Total Revenue, Total Profit, Total Orders, Profit Margin, Revenue Growth.

AI Business Insights

The system uses Google Gemini AI to analyze your sales data and provide actionable business suggestions. Suggestions cover inventory, pricing, marketing, growth, and operations. Each suggestion is tagged with a priority level (High, Medium, Low).

9. Employee Dashboard

When an employee logs in, they see their own dashboard with:

- Summary Stats — Pending Orders, Processing, Shipped Today, Total Products, Total Customers.
- Alert Banners — If there are orders awaiting payment confirmation or unread support messages.
- Recent Orders — Latest orders with status and amount. Click "View All" for full list.
- Quick Actions — Manage Orders, View Products, My Profile, Support Inbox.

10. Order Management (Employee)

Employees manage orders from Employee → Orders.

Viewing & Filtering Orders

- Filter by status tabs: All, Pending Payment, Pending, Inactive, Paid, Processing, Shipped, Delivered, Cancelled.
- Search by order number or customer name.
- Click "View All" to expand beyond the default 15 per page.

Confirming Payments

When a customer pays via mobile money (M-Pesa, Airtel, etc.):

#	Action
1	The order appears with status "Pending" and a confirmation panel.
2	Verify the payment on your mobile money account.
3	Type the customer's full name IN CAPITAL LETTERS as shown in the prompt.
4	Click "Confirm Payment".
5	Order moves to "Paid" status and inventory is deducted.

☐ Cash payments and ClickPesa payments are confirmed automatically. Only mobile money payments require manual confirmation.

Updating Order Status

Use the action buttons to progress orders:

- Mark Processing — Order is being prepared.
- Mark Shipped — Add tracking number and delivery notes, then mark as shipped.
- Mark Delivered — Confirm successful delivery.
- Cancel — Cancel the order (restores inventory).

11. Customer Management (Employee)

Employees can manage customers from Employee → Customers.

- View all registered customers with name, email, and status.
- Search by name or email.
- Add new customers with name, email, and a default password (same as their full name in capitals).
- Toggle Status — Enable or disable a customer account.
- Delete a customer (only if they have no orders).

12. Support Inbox (Employee)

Handle customer support messages from Employee → Support. This is the channel for customer service: customers raise issues here and employees reply. For conversations with your store owner, use Employee → Inbox (see Chapter 13).

Viewing Messages

- Messages are listed with customer name, subject, category, and status.
- Filter by status: All, Open, In Progress, Resolved, Closed.
- Click a message to view the full conversation.

Replying to Customers

#	Action
1	Open the support message.
2	Read the customer's issue.
3	Type your reply in the text box.
4	Click "Send Reply".
5	The customer receives your response in their account.

13. Messaging (Owner & Employee Inbox)

The Inbox is the platform-wide messaging system. Conversations exist between these roles only:

- Owner ↔ Superadmin — Communicate with the system administrator for account issues, subscription questions, or technical support.
- Owner ↔ Customer — Customers can start conversations with you about orders, products, or general inquiries.
- Owner ↔ Employee — Staff and owners can message each other about daily operations, shift notes, or approvals.

□ Customers cannot message the Superadmin directly, and Employees do not see Superadmin conversations. Customers reach the store through Support messages.

Owner Inbox

Open the Inbox from Owner → Inbox. Conversations are grouped into tabs: "All", "Customers", "Staff", and "Admin". Unread conversations show a red badge.

To start a new conversation, click the "+" button. You can pick a customer who ordered from your store or any of your staff members.

Employee Inbox

Employees can message their store owner from Employee → Inbox (next to the Support inbox). The conversation list shows threads with your owner, and the "+" button lets you start a new conversation with your owner directly.

Replying to Messages

#	Action
1	Click on a conversation to open it.
2	Read the message history.
3	Type your reply in the text box at the bottom.
4	Click "Send".

□ Re-sending a message to the same person reuses the existing conversation thread instead of creating duplicates.

Message Read Status (Ticks)

Messages you send show a WhatsApp-style read indicator next to the time stamp. A grey double tick means your message was delivered; it turns blue when the other person opens the conversation and reads it. The status refreshes automatically every few seconds while the Inbox is open.

14. Accounting System

The Accounting System provides full double-entry bookkeeping for your business. Access it from Owner → Accounting.

Chart of Accounts

The system comes with 22 pre-configured default accounts organized into five categories:

- Assets (5 accounts) — Cash, Bank Account, Accounts Receivable, Inventory, Fixed Assets.
- Liabilities (4 accounts) — Accounts Payable, Loans Payable, Tax Payable, Accrued Expenses.
- Equity (4 accounts) — Owner's Equity, Retained Earnings, Capital, Drawings.
- Revenue (4 accounts) — Sales Revenue, Service Revenue, Other Income, Discount Allowed.
- Expenses (5 accounts) — Cost of Goods Sold, Rent, Salaries, Utilities, Office Supplies.

Manage the chart of accounts at `/owner/accounting/chart-of-accounts`. You can:

- Add new accounts with code, name, type, and optional description.
- Edit existing account details.
- Delete accounts that have no transactions.

Journal Entries

Every financial transaction is recorded as a journal entry with a unique reference number in the format JE-YYYYMMDD-XXX.

Journal entries are automatically created for:

- Order Payment — Debits Cash/Bank, Credits Sales Revenue (and Cost of Goods Sold for inventory).
- Order Cancellation — Reverses the original payment entry.
- Purchase Order Receive — Debits Inventory, Credits Accounts Payable.

You can also create manual journal entries for adjustments, corrections, or any other financial transaction. Each entry requires at least two line items (debit and credit) that must balance.

Journal entries follow a three-stage status workflow:

- Draft — Entry is saved but not yet posted to the ledger. Can be edited or deleted.
- Posted — Entry is finalized and reflected in financial reports. Cannot be edited.
- Voided — Entry is cancelled. The original entry remains in the system for audit purposes, but its financial effect is reversed.

Financial Reports

Generate financial reports from /owner/accounting:

- Trial Balance — Lists all accounts with their debit or credit balances. Used to verify that total debits equal total credits.
- Profit & Loss — Shows revenue minus expenses over a period. Displays net profit or loss.
- Balance Sheet — A snapshot of assets, liabilities, and equity at a point in time. Must balance ($\text{Assets} = \text{Liabilities} + \text{Equity}$).
- General Ledger — Detailed view of all transactions for any account. Filter by account and date range.

15. Commissions & Earnings

Commission System

The commission system rewards employees based on the profit they generate, not just revenue. Each employee has a commission rate set by the owner.

How commissions work:

- When an order is marked as Paid, the system calculates profit (Selling Price - Cost Price) for each item.
- $\text{Commission} = \text{Total Profit} \times \text{Employee Commission Rate}$ (e.g., 5% of TSh 200,000 profit = TSh 10,000).
- If the order has zero or negative profit, no commission is generated.
- Commissions are tracked per-employee and accumulated until paid out.

The owner can manage commissions from Owner → Commissions:

- View pending commissions for each employee with profit details.
- Pay Out individual commissions to mark them as paid.
- Pay All to settle all pending commissions at once.

Employee Earnings

Employees can view their own earnings at /employee/earnings. The earnings dashboard displays:

- Total Profit Generated — Total profit from all orders handled by this employee.
- Total Orders — Number of orders with commissions.
- Pending Commission — Commission amount awaiting payout.
- Paid Commission — Total amount that has been paid to the employee.

□ Commissions are purely profit-based with no base salary. This incentivizes employees to focus on selling higher-margin products.

Winga (Street Promoters)

A Winga is a street promoter who brings customers into your shop. You can register wingas for your business (optionally per branch) and pay them a commission for the customers they bring. Wingas are managed from Owner → Wingas; employees can also view and manage them.

How Winga Commissions Work

When an order is placed with a winga attached, the winga's commission rate is added as a percentage increase on the product price. This "winga fee" is included in the customer's total and funds the winga's commission. For example, a 10% winga rate on a TSh 100,000 order

adds TSh 10,000 to the total, which becomes the winga's commission.

Registering a winga:

- Navigate to Owner → Wingas and click "Add Winga".
- Enter the name and phone number.
- Enter the winga's TIN number (TRA Taxpayer Identification Number) and NIDA number for tax compliance.
- Set the commission rate (%) — the percentage added to the sale.
- Optionally assign the winga to a branch.
- Click "Save".

Withholding Tax (TDS)

Tanzania requires a 5% withholding tax (TDS) to be deducted from commission payments. When you pay a winga, the system automatically deducts 5% from the gross commission and records it as Withholding Tax Payable to be remitted to TRA.

Example: A winga with a TSh 10,000 commission receives TSh 9,500, and TSh 500 is withheld for TRA. The journal entries are posted automatically (debit Winga Commission Payable, credit Cash and Withholding Tax Payable).

Paying Winga Commissions

From the winga commissions view, you can:

- View pending commissions per winga with gross, tax (TDS), and net amounts.
- Pay a single commission — the net amount is paid out and the withholding tax is recorded.
- Pay All — settle every pending commission in one action.

□ Commissions are created automatically when an order with a winga is marked as paid. Cancelling an order or returning items reverses the commission proportionally.

16. Inventory Management

Track and manage your stock levels from Owner → Inventory.

Stock Dashboard

The inventory dashboard gives you an at-a-glance overview of your stock:

- Total Variants — The total number of product variants in your catalog.
- Low Stock Count — Number of variants where stock is at or below the reorder level.
- Total Stock Value — Combined value of all inventory based on cost prices.
- Out of Stock Count — Number of variants with zero stock.

Stock Adjustments

Make manual stock adjustments via the adjustment modal:

#	Action
1	Click "Adjust Stock" on the inventory page.
2	Select the product variant to adjust.
3	Choose the adjustment type:
4	— Adjustment: General correction to stock levels.
5	— Damage: Record damaged or spoiled goods.
6	— Opening: Initial stock entry for new products.
7	Enter the quantity (positive to add, negative to reduce).
8	Add notes explaining the reason for adjustment.
9	Click "Save" to record the adjustment.

Transaction History

Every stock change is logged in the transaction history. Each entry shows:

- Type — The reason for the stock change (Sale, Cancellation, Adjustment, Damage, Opening, Purchase Order, etc.).
- Product — The variant that was affected.
- Quantity — The amount added (+) or removed (-).
- Running Balance — The stock level after this transaction.

□ Stock is automatically deducted when orders are paid and restored when orders are cancelled. Purchase order receiving also adds stock automatically.

17. Purchase Orders & Suppliers

Suppliers

Manage your suppliers from Owner → Suppliers. Each supplier record includes:

- Supplier Name — Company or individual name.
- Contact Person — Primary contact at the supplier.
- Email — Supplier email address.
- Phone — Supplier phone number.
- Address — Physical address.

You can add, edit, and delete suppliers. Use the search bar to find suppliers by any field (name, contact, email, phone, or address).

Purchase Orders

Create and manage purchase orders from Owner → Purchase Orders to restock inventory from suppliers.

Creating a Purchase Order:

#	Action
1	Click "Create Purchase Order".
2	Select a supplier from the dropdown.
3	Add line items — for each item, select a product variant, enter quantity and unit cost.
4	Review the total cost.
5	Click "Save" to create the PO in Draft status.

Purchase Order status flow:

- Draft — PO is created but not yet sent to the supplier. Can be edited.
- Ordered — PO has been sent to the supplier. Awaiting delivery.
- Received — Goods have been received. Inventory is automatically updated and journal entries are created (debit Inventory, credit Accounts Payable).

Supplier Portal

Suppliers have their own login portal to view purchase orders addressed to them. From the supplier portal, suppliers can:

- View all their purchase orders and current status.
- Update Status — Mark orders as dispatched or delivered.
- View Details — See line items, quantities, and costs.

□ The supplier portal streamlines communication between your business and suppliers, reducing the need for phone calls or emails to track orders.

18. Stock Alerts

Low Stock Detection

The system automatically monitors inventory levels and creates stock alerts when thresholds are breached. Alerts are generated based on the reorder level set for each product variant.

Two types of alerts are created:

- Low Stock — Created when a variant's quantity is at or below its reorder level but still above zero. Indicates that stock needs to be replenished soon.
- Out of Stock — Created when a variant's quantity reaches zero. Indicates an urgent need to restock.

Alerts are checked and created automatically whenever inventory changes (e.g., when an order is paid, a stock adjustment is made, or a purchase order is received).

Managing Alerts

View and manage stock alerts from Owner → Stock Alerts.

Filter alerts by status:

- All — Shows all alerts regardless of status.
- Active — Shows only unresolved alerts that need attention.
- Acknowledged — Alerts that have been seen but not yet resolved.
- Resolved — Alerts that have been addressed (stock replenished).

Available actions on alerts:

- Acknowledge — Mark an alert as seen. This moves it from Active to Acknowledged status, indicating you are aware of the issue.
- Resolve — Mark an alert as resolved. This should be done after the stock has been replenished or the issue has been addressed.

□ Setting appropriate reorder levels for each product variant ensures you receive timely low stock alerts before running out of popular items.

19. Customer Shopping Experience

Customers can browse and buy products from the storefront.

Browsing Products

- The home page shows featured products and categories.
- Use the category navigation to filter by type.
- Click any product to see its full details, variants, and pricing.

Adding to Cart

#	Action
1	Select a product variant (color/storage) if applicable.
2	Choose the quantity.
3	Click "Add to Cart".
4	The cart icon in the header updates with the item count.

20. Checkout & Payment

#	Action
1	Click the Cart icon and review your items.
2	Click "Proceed to Checkout".
3	Select or add a delivery address.
4	Choose delivery option: Pickup (free) or Home Delivery (shipping fee calculated automatically based on your city).
5	Select a payment method: Cash, M-Pesa, Airtel Money, Mixx by Yas, or Halopesa.
6	If paying via mobile money, enter your phone number.
7	Click "Place Order".
8	For Cash: Your order is confirmed immediately. Collect at the shop.
9	For Mobile Money: Send payment to the displayed number. Your order will be confirmed by staff.

21. My Account (Customer)

Customers can manage their account from My Account.

- Dashboard — See order stats: Total Orders, In Progress, Delivered.
- Order History — View all past orders with status and details.
- Support — Send messages about payment issues, order status, delivery, or refund requests. View replies from staff.
- Profile — Update name and personal information.
- Password — Change your password (must meet security requirements).
- Addresses — Manage saved delivery addresses.

22. Language Settings

The system supports two languages: English and Kiswahili.

#	Action
1	Click the language toggle in the top navigation bar.
2	Select English or Kiswahili.
3	The entire interface switches instantly — no page reload needed.

□ Your language preference is saved and persists across sessions.

23. Password Policy

All passwords must meet the following requirements:

- At least 8 characters long.
- At least one uppercase letter (A-Z).
- At least one lowercase letter (a-z).
- At least one number (0-9).
- At least one special character (!@#\$%...).

Forced Password Change

If your password has never been changed or was last changed more than 3 days ago, a mandatory password change modal will appear on login. You must set a new password before accessing the system.

Employee Default Password

When the owner creates a new employee account, the default password is the employee's full name in capital letters (e.g., "MATHEW ZACHARIA"). Employees should change this immediately on first login.

Owner Default Password

When a new owner account is created by the system administrator, the default password is the owner's full name in capital letters (e.g., "JOHN DOE"). The administrator shares this password securely with the owner.

24. Session & Security

Automatic Logout (Inactivity)

For your security, the system automatically signs you out after 15 minutes of inactivity. Moving the mouse, clicking, or typing resets the timer.

When you have been inactive for 14 minutes, a warning appears with a 60-second countdown. Any mouse or keyboard activity dismisses the warning and keeps you signed in. When the countdown reaches zero, you are signed out and returned to the login page.

Leaving the Dashboard

If you switch to another tab or application, the timer pauses. When you return within 10 minutes, your session continues. If you are away for longer than 10 minutes, the system signs you out to protect your account.

Login Security

To protect your account against unauthorized access:

- Login attempts are limited to 5 per minute per IP address.
- After 5 failed attempts, the account locks automatically for 30 minutes.
- New account registrations are limited to 3 per minute and 10 per day per IP address.

□ If your account becomes locked, wait 30 minutes and try again, or contact your system administrator for assistance.